followed by tripartite discussions between the British, Chinese and Tibetans to delineate a boundary line between Inner and Outer Tibet, as well as between Outer Tibet and British India. During the Second World War, India also served as a staging base to send assistance and war material to the Chinese Nationalists led by Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek, who were fighting the Japanese. Yet, on India's part, these exchanges or activities were controlled by the British Government of India and conducted in the defence of their Empire; Indians, for the most part, were mere bystanders.

Therefore, in the true sense, India's diplomatic activity with China in the modern age really started after 1947, and especially with the founding of the People's Republic of China in 1949. Despite the vast political experience of India's first-generation leadership after Independence, they had had limited opportunities of handling diplomatic relations, and the civil service was trained in the British methods and mindsets of diplomacy. The Chinese Communists, on the other hand, had greater experience in dealing with foreign powers from the 1930s up to 1949, including with Stalin's Soviet Union, which was their fraternal partner, the Americans and the British, who were their allies in the Second World War, as well as the Japanese. Moreover, China had a generally unbroken tradition of diplomacy because, unlike India, it was never directly governed by colonial powers and the Chinese Empire continued to have external relations. The leaderships of India and China were, thus, unevenly matched in terms of diplomatic experience when both became masters of their respective countries at the end of the 1940s.

In 1948, the Republic of China (the precursor to the current Communist government), then still based on the mainland, sent Dr Luo Jia-Lun as their ambassador to interact with the leaders of newly independent India. Within a short time, it